

Can you cut 5% of workforce cost without losing your best people?

ONE DATASET, THREE LEVERS

2,004 employees

47 roles

Hiring freeze · Delayering · Targeted layoffs



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DATA ANALYTICS PORTFOLIO · PROJECT 5



The CHRO wants 5% off workforce cost — without losing critical talent

BASELINE

\$292.3M

fully-loaded annual workforce cost, Meridian Cloud

TARGET

\$14.6M

5% savings, without hollowing out critical roles

THREE LEVERS TESTED

Hiring freeze

Delaying

Targeted layoffs

Every role gets an **A / B / B-HR / C** tag before any lever touches it

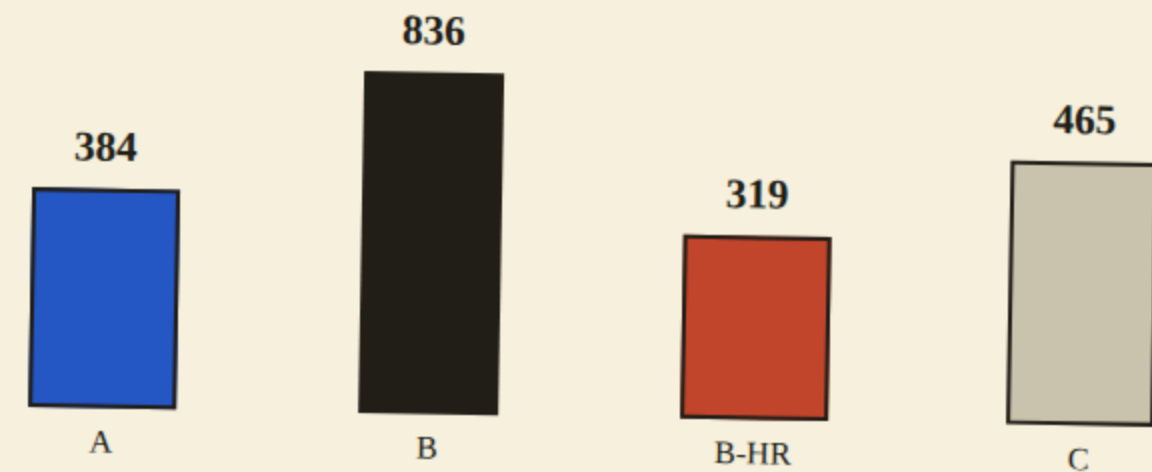
A Strategic impact **and** performance variance clears threshold

B-HR Not strategic, but few backups **and** long time-to-hire

B Supports an A-role, or strategic without clearing variance

C Everything else — the lever-eligible pool

2,004 EMPLOYEES, BY TAG



The hiring freeze clears the savings bar — then quietly guts critical roles

NET SAVINGS VS. 5% TARGET

5.6%

clears the target — attrition alone covers the cost line

PROTECTED POSITIONS LOST

77–90

A and B-HR roles that leave anyway, with no control over who

FAIL

freezing hiring can't tell attrition which roles matter — it fails the protection criterion, not the cost one



Targeted layoffs pass — and keep passing far past the plan

NET SAVINGS AT PLAN

5.02%

clears the 5% target, ranked by lowest net contribution first

PASS

NET SAVINGS % AS SEVERANCE ASSUMPTION RISES



assumption was 2 weeks of severance per year of tenure — the plan holds to roughly 5x that before it breaks



Built live in Power BI — sliders instead of re-running the model

